

TRANSFER Mania



RAGHUNATH MOHANTY

Panchayati Raj and Parliamentary Affairs Minister
Also a senior BJP leader, Mohanty tops the list of recommending transfers and postings by sending off 877 letters.



DEBI MISHRA

Excise and Tourism Minister
Heads the Excise Department and follows close on Mohanty's heels with 318 memos recommending transfers, especially of junior employees.



A.U. SINGHDEO

Works and Housing Minister
Patnaik's school buddy, he kept the transfer industry buzzing by writing out 283 transfers and postings of state government employees.



SURYO PATRO

Energy, IT and Culture Minister
At the helm of three ministries, he used his proximity to the chief minister to issue 255 letters recommending transfers and postings.

have in recommending the transfer of a primary school headmaster? Ministers have no such powers, say officials. Besides, it amounted to clear interference in the administrative work of other departments. As Congress spokesperson Kailash Acharya says, "Call it personal interest, vested interest, money-for-transfer or favours, they all did it in a nebulous manner."

Acharya says that there were standard rules for transfers and postings which were blatantly violated by the ministers. "This reflects what governance means under Naveen Raj," he says. The system of transfers and postings in Orissa administration is unambiguous in official rulebooks with the powers of each higher official properly laid down. The director of a department can transfer Class 3 employees and, in some cases, Class 2 officers while department secretaries can transfer Class 1 and Class 2 officers. Biswajit says that the rules clearly mentioned that ministers in Orissa don't have the power to effect transfers and postings of Class 3 officials. The ministers seem to be least bothered by such rules.

It is not only the BJP ministers who ran transfer-posting operations; there were a few BJP ministers as well. "I had had asked for the same details from BJP ministers but no information came forth," says Biswajit. The office of BJP's Sameer Dey got back saying they "need a month's time to compile the list of recommendation letters". Dey resigned as higher education minister after levelling corruption charges against Patnaik. The BJP's Manmohan Samal, who quit as revenue minister following his alleged links to a sex scandal, simply did not respond.

The revelations, on the eve of the elections, have embarrassed the Patnaik Government, which has broken away from its alliance with the BJP. The transfer-posting scam has given the Opposition a convenient handle to attack Patnaik's claim of good governance. It's a charge he cannot transfer to anyone else.

who was to be transferred to Upper Indravati Irrigation Department, be posted to the "control of chief engineer, drainage, Cuttack". In a letter to the excise commissioner, he recommended the transfer of a junior clerk from Nuapada to Ganjam "in view of some genuine difficulties". In most cases, Mishra said the person concerned was from his constituency. What business did the excise minister

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Engineer-in-Chief (I),
Water Resources Deptt.,
Orissa.

One Sri Lalatendu Jena, Jr. Engineer, Irrigation
No. 3582 who is now under orders of transfer to Upper
Indravati Irrigation Project.

Hence, his transfer order may be modified and he
may be posted to the control of Chief engineer, Drainage,
Cuttack.

COMMISSIONER-CUM-SECRETARY,
HEALTH & F.W. ORISSA

Dr. Binai Chandra Rath Asst. Surgeon now working at S.C.B.
Medical College Cuttack may please be transferred and posted as such in
Bacteriological and Pathological Laboratory Zila Cuttack in the existing
vacancy.

MINISTER HIGHER EDUCATION
AND PG & PA

LETTERS RECOMMENDING TRANS-
FERS OF AN ASSISTANT SURGEON
(LEFT) AND AN IRRIGATION ENGINEER